Medication Safety

BEFORE

Verify the order, patient, allergies, indication, dose, route and timing.

DURING

Follow independent double-check requirements and avoid unsafe interruptions.

AFTER

Document administration and monitor therapeutic effect and adverse reactions.

If anything is unclear, pause and consult the supervisor or pharmacist.

Seven Rights of Medication Administration

01
Right patient

02
Right medication

03
Right dose

04
Right time

05
Right route

06
Right reason

07
Right documentation

High-Alert Medications

- Use the current institutional high-alert medication list and approved warning labels.
- Store high-alert medicines separately when the local policy requires segregation.
- Complete an independent double-check for specified medicines, doses and routes.
- Confirm calculations, concentration, infusion settings and monitoring requirements.
- Escalate any mismatch or uncertainty before the medication reaches the patient.







Look-Alike and Sound-Alike Medicines

READ

Read the full generic name, strength, dosage form and route.

COMPARE

Compare the medication label with the order at each handling step.

SEPARATE

Follow local storage separation and warning-label requirements.

CLARIFY

Confirm unclear verbal orders, abbreviations or similar names with the prescriber or pharmacist.

Examples in older training materials may change. Always use the current institutional LASA list.

Look-Alike and Sound-Alike Medicines

LASA

Look Alike Sound Alike

Sound Alike:

LOSEC 40 mg	LASIX 40 mg
doBUTamine	DUPamine
cloZAPINE	cloNAZEPAM

Look Alike:





Medication Errors and Near Misses

MEDICATION ERROR

A preventable event that may cause or lead to inappropriate medication use or patient harm.

NEAR MISS

An error detected before it reaches the patient.

HAZARDOUS SITUATION

A condition that increases the chance of an error, such as similar packaging or unsafe abbreviations.

SIGNIFICANT ERROR

An error with potential for serious or permanent harm and urgent escalation needs.

Response to a Medication Error

- Assess the patient, provide immediate care and call the responsible clinician.
- Notify pharmacy and patient safety according to the institutional reporting pathway.
- Document clinical facts in the health record and complete the separate incident report.
- Support root cause analysis to identify system factors and required corrective actions.
- Share approved safety lessons with relevant teams while protecting confidentiality.